

Damien GUESDON

VP ENGINEERING / DIRECTOR OF IT INFRASTRUCTURE

Critical Infrastructure, DevOps/SRE, FinOps & MLOps Governance
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

As an IT Executive with over 20 years of technology experience, combining deep technical expertise with a proven track record in executive leadership (up to CTO), I specialize in talent management, scaling engineering organizations, and strategic IT Governance. Leveraging my foundational background in critical infrastructure resilience, I direct highly distributed, mission-critical environments enforcing strict **SLI/SLO standards**, **error budgets**, and requiring zero-downtime operations. Author of the essay *"SophiA, Supreme Assistant?"* detailing technological sovereignty, I bridge the gap between executive leadership and secure **MLOps platforms**, pioneering **AI-assisted operations**. My objective is to empower cross-functional teams, optimize P&L, align technical roadmaps with the company's vision, and drive absolute operational excellence.

KEY SKILLS

Strategy & Leadership (C-Level):

Aligning IT with business goals, global roadmap execution, Servant Leadership, leading cross-functional technical departments (18+ staff), driving a culture of profitability.

SRE & Critical Infrastructure:

High availability (SLA and SLO), system resilience, network and infrastructure observability, and operational scaling for heavy-traffic operations.

Cloud, MLOps & Governance:

Overseeing DevOps teams (Kubernetes, microservices), CI/CD standards, sovereign AI architecture design, and maintaining ISO 27001 / HDS compliance.

Vendor & Contract Management (FinOps):

Strategic competitive bidding, end-to-end procurement strategy, and drastic OPEX/CAPEX reductions.

M&A & Transformation:

IT due diligence, harmonization, and integration of complex technological infrastructures.

Core Technical Foundations:

Deep expertise in Linux/Unix OS (30 years hands-on), advanced routing & switching fundamentals (exceeding CCNA level), and distributed systems troubleshooting.

LANGUAGES

- French: Native
- English: Fluent (including technical)
- Catalan: In progress

EDUCATION

MSc in AI Engineering, OpenClassrooms, 2026

Technical engineering curriculum (Data Science & MLOps). Final project focused on IT governance and sovereign architecture.

Higher Technical Diploma (BTS), IT Resource Mgmt, 2005-2006

IT Resource Management Specialist

Higher National Diploma (BTS), Analyst Programmer, CNFDI, 2001

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer (CTO) - Infrastructure - Alphaslink

France - Jan 2024 - May 2025

- Cross-functional Team Leadership (Servant Leadership):** Led a highly distributed, 18-person engineering department, including managing technical leaders and **managers** across 4 specialized hubs (VoIP, Network, R&D, Datacenter) to rally talent, empower experts, and optimize operational excellence.
- Cloud-native Modernization & Reliability:** Spearheaded the technological evolution of a legacy, sovereign infrastructure across a distributed network of privately owned and colocation datacenters. Guided the engineering teams through the **cloud-native modernization** of heavy-duty physical backbones (Cisco, Palo Alto), establishing strict observability standards that successfully drove down **MTTR**.
- Strategic FinOps & Budgeting:**
 - Network Merger Project:** Overhauled the procurement strategy against an initial **€130M** quote (Cisco). Orchestrated competitive bidding and rigorously optimized the target architecture, successfully delivering the final project for **€2M**.
 - Office 365 Licensing:** Conducted capacity audits and contract renegotiation, generating **€70K** in recurring annual savings.
- IT Governance & Cybersecurity:** Established and chaired the cross-departmental Change Advisory Board (CAB) to enforce strict delivery discipline. Architected a next-generation SOC infrastructure (Palo Alto) and successfully managed the renewal of 4 major ISO certifications (ISO 27001, 9001, 22301, and HDS).

Fractional CTO & AI Architect - KISAI R&D

Full Remote (Andorra / France) - Since June 2025

- Executive Consulting (Fractional CTO):** Continuing my consulting practice established in 2018. Providing ad-hoc strategic and technical guidance to executives on critical infrastructure and core network transformations.
- R&D & Innovation Strategy:** Conceptualizing and developing "SophiA" (Sovereign Orchestrator Platform for Holistic Intelligence Architecture), a sovereign B2B AI architecture model (on-premise) integrating **MLOps** best practices and exploring **AI-assisted operations** to eliminate "Shadow AI" data leakage risks and improve engineering productivity.
- Strategic Upskilling (Completed):** Dedicated prioritized bandwidth during this period to successfully acquire an MSc in AI Engineering, officially bridging the gap between traditional heavy infrastructure and modern Machine Learning workloads.

Interim IT Director & Infrastructure Architect (Dedicated Mandate)

Full Remote (France / International) - 2018 - 2023

- Complex Deployments & International Operations:** Architected and supervised infrastructures for ISPs. Provided global remote leadership, managing international infrastructures and distributed technical teams across multiple countries (France, Portugal, Mauritius, Luxembourg, Morocco...).
- Security & Compliance:** Steered the deployment of resilient foundations enabling strict adherence to security standards (facilitating ISO 27001 and HDS certification renewals).
- High-Availability Architecture:** Designed and integrated robust operator backbones and datacenters requiring zero-downtime operational standards.

Technical Director & Lead Architect (Dedicated Mandate)

Full Remote (France) - 2011 - 2018

- Deployed and managed operator backbones, datacenters, and MPLS networks.
- Led network engineering and ISP service integrations, focusing on high availability designs.

Previous Experience (SysAdmin & Network)

France - 2005 - 2011

- ALPHALINK** (2008-2011): Network Architect - Designed architectures, managed technical projects.
- PYGRAM** (2007-08): Systems & Network Manager (VmWare, TSE).
- Renault / BI-SAM / BNP Paribas** (2005-07): Systems Administrator & IT Support in large-scale enterprise environments.